

Magic Quadrant for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services

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Infrastructure platform consumption service vendors deliver integrated storage and compute technologies via intelligent, SLA-backed hybrid cloud platforms. Heads of I&O can use this Magic Quadrant to benchmark these hybrid as-a-service platform providers and inform modern infrastructure strategies.

Strategic Planning Assumptions

- By 2029, consumption-based storage as a service (STaaS) will replace 50% of on-premises enterprise storage and data services infrastructure capital expenditure (capex), an increase from 20% in 2026.
- By 2029, more than 30% of on-premises servers will be provided through a consumption-based, as-a-service solution, up from less than 20% in 2026.
- By 2029, more than 40% of SLA-as-code (SLAaC) data storage platforms will rely on governance agents to arbitrate outcome trade-offs, up from less than 1% in 2026.

Market Definition/Description

Gartner defines the infrastructure platform consumption services (IPCS) market as solutions delivering mission-critical infrastructure, such as storage and compute, on a consumption-based, as-a-service model, managed through the platform vendor's control plane. IPCS offerings typically include storage as a service (STaaS), and compute as a service (CaaS), and

data services like data protection, analytics and databases. These services are delivered with SLA-backed outcomes, leveraging automation and software-defined infrastructure.

The primary role of IPCS is to provide scalable, platform-managed infrastructure for hybrid-cloud environments, enabling organizations to shift from capital expenditure and in-house management toward a consumption-based operating model. This approach allows IT operations to focus on managing workloads rather than physical hardware, with vendors assuming responsibility and risk management for infrastructure performance and reliability. IPCS delivers benefits such as cost optimization, improved productivity, enhanced cyber resilience and accelerated innovation — driven by automation, continuous workload optimization and product-centric service features.

Mandatory Features

Mandatory features for the IPCS market include support for:

- STaaS for storage platform providers
- CaaS for compute platform providers
- A centralized API-driven control plane for infrastructure orchestration, provisioning and asset life cycle management
- A domain-specific (e.g., storage, compute), as-a-service offering that is native (e.g., core intellectual property) to the vendor's platform control plane
- A central telemetry capability for monitoring, observability and proactive SLA management
- A customer self-service portal for managing as-a-service features and operations, such as metering, billing and capacity additions
- A domain-specific enterprise platform data storage management service
- Optimizing domain-specific usage and utilization levels based on the use of AI/machine learning (ML) telemetry

Optional Features

Optional features for the IPCS market include support for:

- Compute as a service

- Data protection as a service, like disaster recovery as a service (DRaaS), backup as a service (BaaS) and managed archive, which are provided natively or in collaboration with an independent software vendor partner to support data resilience and recovery scenarios
- Continuous upgrades over the life cycle of the agreement
- A controller runtime environment in which to integrate SLA-based code (codification) to support automation initiatives in line with SLAs
- Flexible domain-centric consumption licensing options that offer various pricing scenarios
- A portfolio of IT operating model SLAs, such as productivity and efficiency, asset management and financing, cyber data resilience, governance and data services rapid innovation
- A platform-native software-defined disaggregated architecture to support flexible and modern agile operations for hybrid-cloud infrastructure workload deployment models
- A sustainability SLA offering to monitor, report and manage power and CO2 emissions
- A platform-native FinOps tool to support consumption-based usage, billing and infrastructure arbitrage methods
- Autonomous, threshold-based platform capabilities, such as the use of AI/ML telemetry to drive proactive workload outcomes and data placement
- Support, including partnering and integrating third-party vendors, for a more complete platform infrastructure services stack
- Domain-specific features and capabilities that support AI applications/workloads
- An API that supports automation efforts or integration into other platform engineering use cases

Magic Quadrant

Figure 1: Magic Quadrant for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services



Magic Quadrant for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services



Gartner

Vendor Strengths and Cautions

Dell Technologies

Dell Technologies is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its Dell APEX and Dell Private Cloud solutions portfolios are broadly focused on delivering disaggregated, consumption-based hybrid cloud platforms managed through the unified Dell Automation Platform. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. Dell continues to invest in platform intelligence by integrating agentic AI operations natively into its control plane and expanding automated AI model deployment pipelines.

Strengths

- **Predictable consumption economics:** Dell APEX consumption services provide a consistent unit rate for committed baseline and additional on-demand usage with no overage fees and no minimum-commitment shortfall fees. These services also have a capacity billing cap to ensure financial predictability and prevent upfront overprovisioning.
- **Flexible hypervisor portability:** Multihypervisor flexibility allows organizations to offset VMware option licensing costs. This is made possible by using Dell's native, validated integrations through Dell Private Cloud for Red Hat OpenShift, Nutanix AHV, and Microsoft Azure Local.
- **Proactive telemetry intelligence:** By leveraging artificial intelligence trained on over 1 million active global telemetry systems, the platform predicts and automatically resolves complex infrastructure anomalies before they disrupt production databases or applications.

Cautions

- **Multiple storage data plane architectures:** Dell's underlying platform storage portfolio relies on four distinct operating system kernels. Managing a multiarray Dell estate requires IT teams to maintain separate replication engines and navigate distinct operational runbooks.
- **Limited SLA-as-code functionality:** Dell does not yet expose a formal, outcome-based policy layer that translates SLAs, compliance obligations, or data sovereignty requirements into continuously enforced runtime constraints known as SLA-as-code. As a result, IT administrative teams must rely on manual, reactive auditing processes, increasing operational overhead.
- **Platform onboarding complexity:** Dell customers report upfront operational complexity when authoring custom platform blueprints and configuring initial APEX subscription contract frameworks.

Everpure

Everpure, formerly Pure Storage, is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its Purity operating system and Evergreen//One portfolios deliver a highly consolidated, software-defined hybrid cloud platform managed through the autonomous Pure1 control plane. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises.

Everpure continues to invest in platform intelligence by embedding generative AI copilots natively within its analytics engine and expanding automated, zero-downtime controller upgrade cycles.

Strengths

- **Unified enterprise data cloud:** Customers benefit from a unified data platform providing consistent storage, data management, governance, and mobility services across on-premises, edge, and cloud environments. This simplifies hybrid operations, reduces data silos, and provides a simplified operating model.
- **Automated operational capabilities:** The platform utilizes automated control-plane capabilities to deliver predictive analytics and telemetry-driven insights for performance and capacity workload management. This reduces manual day-to-day administrative intervention and helps accelerate issue resolution against defined requirements.
- **SLA-backed utility outcomes:** Financial and operations leaders benefit from a consumption model backed by contractually guaranteed service-level agreements (SLAs). These contractual guarantees provide predictable outcomes for performance, availability, and capacity, aligning infrastructure spending with actual operational requirements.

Cautions

- **Economics favor larger deployments:** Smaller customer deployments are susceptible to reduced economic benefits due to higher initial baseline commitments and premium pricing for advanced service tiers. Midmarket organizations or those with distributed edge environments risk incurring upfront charges for overprovisioned capacity thresholds and performance minimums they do not fully utilize.
- **Partner-dependent platform stack:** Customers looking for an end-to-end private cloud offering from a single provider could face added integration complexity, vendor management overhead, and potential interoperability challenges when combining Everpure with partnered infrastructure solutions.
- **Cloud connectivity dependence:** Everpure's automation, predictive operations, and SLA management capabilities rely on continuous telemetry collection and cloud-based analytics. Organizations operating in air-gapped environments or with restrictive data-transfer requirements risk limited access to the full value of the platform's autonomous operations capabilities.

Fujitsu

Fujitsu is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. Its uSCALE platform delivers consumption-based compute, storage, container, and hybrid cloud services, including PRIMERGY x86 servers, Kubernetes platforms, STaaS, and partner-integrated solutions with NetApp and Nutanix. Its operations are geographically diversified across Japan and Europe, but its presence outside these regions remains limited, and its clients span manufacturing, retail, healthcare, financial services, government, and IT services. Fujitsu continues to invest in NetApp Keystone integration, Nutanix Cloud Clusters support, ETERNUS storage enhancements, and private AI offerings through Kozuchi.

Fujitsu declined requests for supplemental information. Gartner's analysis is therefore based on other credible sources.

Strengths

- **Sovereign platform innovation:** Fujitsu's sovereign platform supports the full generative AI life cycle in dedicated environments. This enables enterprises to operationalize AI while maintaining control over sensitive data.
- **Trusted AI governance:** Fujitsu differentiates itself through integrated AI trust, governance, and security capabilities, including guardrails and vulnerability scanning. These are designed to support enterprise and regulated-industry requirements.
- **Industry-specific AI solutions:** For regulated industries, Fujitsu increasingly aligns its infrastructure and platform strategy with industry-focused AI outcomes for financial services and healthcare. It emphasizes domain-specific models, AI agents, and sector-tailored solutions.

Cautions

- **Limited global reach:** Organizations outside Fujitsu's core markets are susceptible to encountering a smaller customer reference base, less local market visibility, and fewer ecosystem resources. These factors present a risk of reduced market familiarity and available support, potentially impacting vendor selection and deployment planning.
- **Limited ecosystem scale:** Compared with other enterprise platform providers, Fujitsu offers a more limited ecosystem of platform services, third-party integrations, and partner-led innovation.

- **Partner technology dependence:** Fujitsu relies on partners such as NetApp, Nutanix, Red Hat, and SUSE for important elements of its platform portfolio. This introduces additional vendor coordination, support, and roadmap dependencies for organizations seeking a highly integrated platform experience.

HPE

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. HPE centers its hybrid cloud platform strategy on GreenLake, providing a unified operating experience across compute, storage, networking, private cloud and hybrid IT operations, with flexible consumption models through GreenLake Flex Solutions. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. HPE is actively investing in autonomous operations with the HPE GreenLake Intelligence and deepening native hypervisor integrations under HPE Morpheus Software to provide a complete alternative to traditional virtualization stacks.

Strengths

- **Enterprise viability:** IT organizations benefit from HPE's global support and professional services capabilities, broad partner ecosystem, and diversified business across compute, storage, networking, and services. This scale provides confidence in HPE's ability to support multiyear hybrid cloud initiatives, consumption commitments, and enterprisewide infrastructure standardization.
- **Unified platform experience:** Infrastructure administrators are able to manage virtual machines, containers, and bare-metal resources across core, colocation, and edge environments through a common GreenLake operating model. This provides consistent governance, provisioning, and life cycle management across distributed infrastructure.
- **Flexible consumption economics:** HPE's GreenLake Flex Solutions portfolio provides customers with a range of flexible consumption and commitment options that support alignment of infrastructure spending with changing business requirements. This reduces operational and financial challenges associated with changes in workloads.

Cautions

- **Vertical industry coverage:** Organizations with specialized industry requirements may require partner technologies and services to address HPE's native compliance, sovereignty, and operational capabilities.

- **Manual SLA reconciliation:** HPE's SLA credit process remains reactive rather than automated. Customers must submit a formal SLA credit claim ticket and provide supporting evidence of the outage or service unavailability.
- **Steep onboarding curve:** Organizations adopting advanced GreenLake capabilities and CloudOps Software across complex distributed environments may require operational process changes and specialized skill development, resulting in an operational learning curve that can extend the timeline required to achieve full platform maturity and value.

Hitachi Vantara

Hitachi Vantara is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its VSP One and EverFlex portfolios are broadly focused on delivering software-defined storage, unified hybrid cloud management, and consumption-based data services. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. Hitachi Vantara is actively investing in platform intelligence by integrating AI-driven observability into its control plane and expanding its partner-led go-to-market (GTM) relationships.

Strengths

- **Unified platform architecture:** Organizations are able to manage block, file, and object workloads through a common architecture and control plane. This reduces operational complexity and enables more consistent data services across on-premises and hybrid cloud environments.
- **Resilient recovery innovation:** Infrastructure and security teams benefit from automated recovery workflows, isolated recovery environments, and cyber resiliency offerings designed to accelerate recovery from ransomware and other disruptive events. These capabilities also improve operational confidence through validated clean recovery and clean data assurance.
- **Stable corporate viability:** Customers seeking long-term consumption relationships gain from Hitachi Vantara's backing by Hitachi Ltd. It provides confidence in the vendor's ability to support multiyear infrastructure investments, service commitments, and roadmap execution.

Cautions

- **Siloed operational delivery:** Hitachi Vantara's VSP One Platform lacks native full-stack capabilities and hypervisor orchestration. This introduces multivendor integration overhead

that adds operational complexity.

- **Complex SLA policy configuration:** IT administrators are prone to facing a complex initial deployment process and a steep learning curve when configuring automated SLA agents. This complexity can delay time to value and increase reliance on specialized skills or vendor support.
- **Limited consumption adoption:** Hitachi Vantara's continued focus on hardware-centric offerings is prone to limiting the pace at which customers adopt its fully software-defined and utility-based EverFlex consumption model.

Huawei

Huawei is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its Datacenter Virtualization Solution (DCS) delivers integrated, full-stack hybrid cloud platforms spanning managed compute, storage, networking, and hypervisor environments. Its operations are geographically diversified, with limited North American presence, primarily serving large enterprise and public-sector clients across Asia/Pacific, Europe, the Middle East, and Africa. Huawei is actively investing in AI-driven platform orchestration by embedding deep learning natively within its iMaster DME control plane and engineering a turnkey, low-latency AI training, inference, and enterprise-level agent development platform.

Strengths

- **Integrated technology stack:** Customers benefit from a tightly integrated architecture spanning silicon, compute, virtualization, storage, and management software. This simplifies deployment, reduces interoperability challenges, and provides a more consistent performance and life cycle management across environments.
- **Industry-focused solutions:** Organizations in regulated industries are able to leverage prevalidated industry-specific architectures and compliance-oriented designs. This accelerates deployment timelines and reduces the effort required to address security, governance, and data residency requirements.
- **Autonomous operations:** IT administrators benefit from AI-enabled operations and automation capabilities within the management platform. This reduces operational overhead, improves resource utilization, and helps teams respond more quickly to changing infrastructure demands.

Cautions

- **Migration and portability challenges:** Organizations moving to Huawei's infrastructure stack may incur additional migration effort and face portability constraints when replacing existing virtualization, management, and hardware platforms. These transitions can also require workforce upskilling and operational change management.
- **Complex commercial structure:** Huawei's consumption offerings are susceptible to complex pricing structures, regional commercial variations, and deployment-specific contract terms. These issues result in customers experiencing longer evaluation and contracting cycles, particularly for large-scale or multiregion deployments.
- **Constrained regional presence:** Huawei's presence in certain markets is affected by geopolitical factors, trade restrictions, and regulatory policies. This creates challenges for organizations pursuing globally standardized infrastructure, partner, and support models.

IBM

IBM is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its Power Virtual Server, Cloud Virtual Servers, and Storage Fusion portfolios are broadly focused on delivering hybrid cloud infrastructure, software-defined container storage, and managed consumption-based enterprise services. Its operations are geographically diversified, and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. IBM continues to invest in platform intelligence by integrating watsonx GenAI capabilities into its hybrid control plane and expanding automated storage provisioning workflows.

Strengths

- **Hybrid cloud integration:** IBM combines IBM Fusion, Red Hat OpenShift, and its broader hybrid cloud portfolio to provide a consistent operating model for data and applications across on-premises and cloud environments. This improves workload portability and streamlines operations across distributed environments.
- **Enterprise operational requirements:** Organizations benefit from IBM's experience supporting complex, mission-critical environments through its reference architectures, governance frameworks, and consulting expertise. These capabilities help accelerate deployment, improve operational consistency, and simplify security, compliance, and resilience requirements across a broad range of industries.
- **Enterprise transformation partner:** Infrastructure buyers benefit from IBM's longstanding enterprise presence, global services organization, and financial stability. This provides

customers with confidence in the vendor's ability to support long-term infrastructure strategies, multiyear consumption agreements, and ongoing platform investments.

Cautions

- **Complex customer experience:** Enterprise IT teams report challenges navigating IBM's organizational structure and multiple support channels when resolving issues across hybrid infrastructure environments. This necessitates a higher level of coordination effort and managed services offerings that is prone to extending resolution timelines for some customers.
- **Fragmented consumption portfolio:** IBM's infrastructure consumption capabilities span multiple product, software, and service portfolios, resulting in a fragmented management and consumption experience. This scenario requires the use of separate tools and interfaces to administer infrastructure resources across domains.
- **Constrained commercial flexibility:** IBM's consumption contracts require separate baseline commitments and pricing tiers across its storage and compute portfolios. Limited flexibility in reducing baseline commitments makes cost optimization challenging for organizations with variable storage demand.

Lenovo

Lenovo is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its TruScale and xIQ Hybrid Cloud Platform portfolios are broadly focused on delivering disaggregated, managed consumption-based hybrid cloud platforms. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. Lenovo is actively investing in platform intelligence by integrating agentic AI operations natively into its control plane and expanding automated AI model deployment pipelines.

Strengths

- **Regulatory compliance support:** Organizations in regulated industries benefit from Lenovo's emphasis on governance, data sovereignty, and compliance-focused infrastructure capabilities. This helps customers address regional regulatory requirements while reducing the operational effort associated with maintaining compliant environments.
- **Flexible infrastructure operations:** IT operations teams benefit from Lenovo's broad infrastructure portfolio of compute, storage, and AI infrastructure options, including

support for multiple accelerator and hardware ecosystems. This provides flexibility to adapt capacity as business needs evolve.

- **Global operational footprint:** System administrators benefit from Lenovo's global supply chain, logistics capabilities, and worldwide service organization. This accelerates deployment timelines, provides greater confidence in long-term consumption, and delivers better pricing and life cycle management commitments.

Cautions

- **Complex storage portfolio architecture:** Lenovo's storage portfolio incorporates multiple platforms and management frameworks acquired and developed over time. Customers evaluating storage solutions may need to navigate a broader set of offerings to identify the platform that best aligns with their technical and operational requirements.
- **Multidomain management toolchains:** Customers deploying the full-stack Lenovo TruScale platform across compute, storage, edge, and AI environments must navigate distinct operational frameworks and management consoles. This toolchain variance requires IT teams to maintain multiple operational workflows and automation scripts across portfolio components.
- **Variable support engagement:** Customers operating complex, hybrid deployments that incorporate third-party storage engines, hypervisors, and AI software require navigating multiple vendor support desks, potentially lengthening issue-resolution timelines for enterprise operations teams.

NetApp

NetApp is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its Keystone and ONTAP portfolios deliver unified, consumption-based hybrid storage platforms and intelligent data services across multicloud environments. Its operations are geographically diversified and its clients tend to be midsize to large global enterprises. NetApp continues to invest in platform intelligence by expanding its NetApp AI Data Engine (AIDE) metadata catalog and integrating automated, zero-copy FlexCache dataset projection adjacent to public cloud GPU compute clusters.

Strengths

- **Unified storage architecture:** Customers benefit from NetApp's consistent ONTAP operating environment across on-premises deployments and major public cloud platforms.

This enables consistent data mobility, operational consistency, and unified management across hybrid cloud environments.

- **Flexible hybrid cloud:** Financial and operations leaders benefit from Keystone's consumption model license capability to support workload mobility across on-premises and cloud environments. This helps organizations adapt efficient capacity and resource allocation as infrastructure requirements evolve.
- **AI-ready data mobility:** Infrastructure administrators are able to leverage NetApp's AIDE and FlexCache technologies to improve data accessibility across distributed AI environments. This reduces data movement overhead, accelerates access to training datasets, and improves resource utilization for AI and data-intensive workloads.

Cautions

- **Service automation governance:** NetApp does not provide prescriptive SLA-as-code (SLAaC) or automated policy enforcement for a governance-based outcome. As a result, IT administrative teams must rely on manual processes.
- **Dual platform operational complexity:** Organizations utilizing both NetApp ONTAP-based storage systems and NetApp StorageGRID object appliances must navigate separate underlying software engines, data paths, and specialized administration tools, resulting in increased operational friction and broader skill-set requirements for I&O teams.
- **Restricted market accessibility:** Keystone's commercial model is generally aligned with enterprise-scale deployments and long-term infrastructure consumption requirements. This limits offerings for organizations pursuing smaller deployments or edge-focused use-case environments.

Vendors Added and Dropped

We review and adjust our inclusion criteria for Magic Quadrants as markets change. As a result of these adjustments, the mix of vendors in any Magic Quadrant may change over time. A vendor's appearance in a Magic Quadrant one year and not the next does not necessarily indicate that we have changed our opinion of that vendor. It may be a reflection of a change in the market and, therefore, changed evaluation criteria, or of a change of focus by that vendor.

Added

- Huawei

Dropped

- Nile
- Join Digital

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

Inclusion Criteria

In addition to Gartner client relevance, as determined by analyst expertise and opinion, providers need to meet the following criteria to qualify for inclusion: You must provide evidence to support some or all of the claims henceforth:

- Must offer at least one platform-as-a-service offering in one or more of the on-premises infrastructure domains: STaaS and compute as a service (CaaS).
- Gartner requires vendors to demonstrate a minimum of \$25 million in average annual run-rate (ARR) consumption revenue for products and services to qualify for inclusion.
- A minimum of 25 active production customers and installations, utilizing features and capabilities that are all generally available (GA) from 30 June 2026.
- Must offer a standardized and extensible catalog of APIs and AI automation for full control, visibility, and management in support of ecosystem options for consistent orchestration and life cycle management and SLAs.
- Platform vendors must support active production customers in two of five major geographic regions (North America; EMEA; Asia/Pacific (APAC); Japan; Latin America).
- Must support a minimum of three of seven use cases with mandatory support for multicloud.
- Must own (not resell) and develop the core infrastructure domain operating system that is native to the vendor platform control plane.
- Must offer data management capabilities to support their own platform capabilities and services.

Exclusion Criteria

- Public cloud infrastructure as a service (IaaS), platform as a service (PaaS), or neocloud providers, including cloud service providers (CSP) that integrate and offer a separate on-premises vendor's core product intellectual property.

Evaluation Criteria

Ability to Execute

Gartner evaluates vendors' ability to offer and support infrastructure platform services that enable customers to achieve their on-premises cloud operating model objectives and benefits. This evaluation covers features available in a vendor's portfolio of products and services that support platform initiatives and capabilities used by a vendor to help customers take advantage of platform capabilities and SLA-based outcomes.

Product or Service evaluates the core capabilities of the STaaS or CaaS offerings, focusing on runtime SLA enforcement, continuous optimization in production, and centralized control-plane capabilities evaluated in tandem with our companion Critical Capabilities report.

Overall Viability evaluates the vendor's financial health and ARR-based consumption revenue scale to ensure they possess the long-term capacity to support multiyear SLA commitments.

Sales Execution/Pricing assesses presales effectiveness, consumption contract flexibility, and how clearly pricing models align with real-time outcome delivery and SLA objectives.

Market Responsiveness/Record measures how agilely a vendor responds to shifting customer demands or market volatility — such as sudden AI demand spikes or hardware supply chain disruptions —while keeping platform SLAs intact.

Marketing Execution assesses how effectively a vendor's messaging influences the market and resonates with both I&O and CFO audiences by elevating the narrative from raw hardware features to outcome-based consumption economics.

Customer Experience measures the quality of SLA delivery, pricing transparency, and support responsiveness, analyzed directly through client inquiries, Peer Insights, and the predictability of business outcomes.

Operations evaluates a vendor’s 24/7 platform organizational structure, global supply chain resilience, and sustainability initiatives to monitor power and CO₂ emissions.

Ability to Execute Evaluation Criteria	
Evaluation Criteria	Weighting
Product or Service	High
Overall Viability	Medium
Sales Execution/Pricing	Medium
Market Responsiveness/Record	Medium
Marketing Execution	High
Customer Experience	High
Operations	Low

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Completeness of Vision

Market Understanding evaluates a vendor’s insight into the fundamental shift from total cost of ownership (TCO)- and capital expenditure (capex)-centric infrastructure to return-on-assets (ROA)-governed, SLA-based consumption platforms, as well as their response to AI-driven volatility, cyber risk, and the VMware virtualization shakeup.

Marketing Strategy measures how clearly and consistently a vendor communicates outcome-based value propositions — such as productivity, resilience, and asset efficiency — and whether they successfully elevate their brand messaging beyond raw hardware specifications.

Sales Strategy evaluates how effectively a vendor is transitioning their channel networks and direct teams from legacy hardware refreshes to proactive, consumption-based GTM strategies.

Offering (Product) Strategy assesses how effectively a vendor’s platform roadmap supports SLA-as-code, multidomain operations, and native hypervisor alternatives managed through a unified control plane.

Business Model evaluates a vendor’s economic architecture, including their financial willingness to absorb capacity utilization risk, media volatility, and life cycle inefficiencies on behalf of the customer.

Vertical/Industry Strategy assesses how strategically a vendor directs development and go-to-market resources to target the unique compliance, security, and operational requirements of specialized industries such as financial services or healthcare.

Innovation evaluates a provider’s leadership in marshaling resources to pioneer disruptive technologies like agentic AI telemetry, closed-loop SLA remediation, and next-generation sovereign AI pipelines.

Geographic Strategy measures how effectively a provider can scale their platform-native services, digital sovereignty compliance, and regional support ecosystems across major global regions.

Completeness of Vision Evaluation Criteria	
Evaluation Criteria	Weighting
Market Understanding	High
Marketing Strategy	High
Sales Strategy	Medium
Offering (Product) Strategy	High
Business Model	Medium

<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Vertical/Industry Strategy	Medium
Innovation	High
Geographic Strategy	Medium

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Quadrant Descriptions

Leaders

Vendors in the Leaders quadrant have the highest composite scores for their Ability to Execute and Completeness of Vision. A Leader has broad market share across major geographies, exceptional brand awareness, recognized outstanding support, robust financial performance, and established enterprise credibility. These vendors are market-driven — they anticipate customer demands over time and make the long-term capital and R&D investment needed to drive platform-native outcomes, advanced technologies, capabilities, and extensive ecosystem partnerships.

Leaders demonstrate a deep, proactive understanding of platform market needs, showing how platform features, combined with platform business model innovations, transform and modernize IT operations. They are recognized innovators and thought leaders, with well-articulated roadmaps that global enterprises can depend on for their long-term hybrid infrastructure strategies.

Challengers

Vendors in the Challengers quadrant participate in major elements of the infrastructure platform market and execute reasonably well to threaten vendors in the Leaders quadrant. Challengers have platform features, core technologies, and nascent or emerging AI-powered SLAs to compete, but lag behind Leaders in the broader elements of a full-scale platform business model or technological innovation to advance platform derivatives.

Challengers have not yet demonstrated long-term and consistent investments in innovation or vision, or they have nascent, leading-edge platform-enabled product capabilities, business

models, and marketing and sales strategies to enable and support the transition to a platform-native service provider leader.

Visionaries

Vendors in the Visionaries quadrant provide leading market-driven infrastructure platform features and innovative platform capabilities across the spectrum of the hybrid IT operations platform stack offerings to address operationally or financially essential end-user demands.

Enterprise storage clients and peers recognize Visionaries for their ability to continuously demonstrate compelling thought leadership and an innovative view of the future for modern IT operations, often introducing disruptive platform initiatives, supporting technologies, or approaches. However, they have not yet demonstrated the ability to capture meaningful platform market share through market-driven sales and marketing initiatives that underpin concrete commercial traction.

There are no Visionaries in this year's Magic Quadrant.

Niche Players

Vendors in the Niche Players quadrant often narrowly focus on specific geographical markets, vertical industry segments, or limited use cases. This quadrant may include vendors that are ramping up their product and platform offerings or larger vendors that are having difficulty developing and executing their vision against new platform market demands.

Context

As enterprise infrastructure scale and operational complexity reach unprecedented levels, organization leaders are rapidly shifting away from legacy hardware ownership toward software-defined, platform-managed pay-for-use consumption-based operating models. The traditional practice of purchasing, overprovisioning, and manually managing stand-alone storage arrays and compute fabrics is proving insufficient in an era defined by new use cases and critical capabilities, distributed data gravity, rising cybersecurity liabilities, data sovereignty requirements, and unpredictable component supply chains.

This Magic Quadrant for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services (IPCS) places a primary emphasis and premium on a platform vendor's ability to deliver mission-critical, SLA-backed

infrastructure utility services across distributed hybrid and multicloud estates, managed through a unified and highly automated platform control plane architecture.

Enterprise buyers must recognize that the IPCS market has matured beyond basic financing mechanisms and capacity-commit leasing. It now represents a fundamental paradigm shift centered on return-on-assets economics, where IT value is measured by asset productivity and business outcomes delivered per dollar invested, rather than raw capacity resource acquisition. The modern IPCS operating model is being shaped by three powerful, converging market dynamics:

- **The transition from AI model experimentation to production-scale inference economics**
- **The widespread virtualization reevaluation triggered by VMware licensing disruption**
- **The rapid rise of digital sovereignty regulations like DORA and the EU AI Act.**

These forces have elevated infrastructure placement and economic governance from routine product feature decisions to strategic platform outcomes that center on board-level concerns.

To maximize the strategic and economic value of IPCS, heads of I&O should take three immediate actions.

- **First, shift the purchasing focus** from raw hardware specifications to contractually guaranteed, written service-level assurances. Buyers should demand comprehensive SLAs for productivity, financial management and asset economics, continuous performance density, continuous workload optimization, rapid innovation and cyber data-resilient environments, backed by automatic billing credits and automated control-plane validation.
- **Second, derisk multicloud deployments** by prioritizing hypervisor and workload portability. Organizations should avoid single-hypervisor lock-in by evaluating platforms that offer native multihypervisor support and data mobility across public cloud and on-premises environments.
- **Finally, align procurement strategies** with actual demand by adopting elastic, pay-per-use consumption models. Rather than committing capital at peak prices during hardware supply shortages, teams should leverage utility models where the vendor absorbs component volatility, allows capacity to scale up and down dynamically without contract renegotiation, and tracks billing directly to realized operational metrics.

Market Overview

The Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services (IPCS) market is rapidly becoming one of the most important enablers of enterprise hybrid cloud platform strategy to address AI-data-ready workloads and other critical use cases. Core to the platform strategy are data sovereignty and protection requirements, and data intelligence-based automation that includes agentic AI-based infrastructure for modern IT operations.

Organizations no longer have to choose between traditional on-premises-only infrastructure and hyperscale cloud. IPCS vendors offer a third path: an on-premises cloud operating model delivered across enterprise-controlled data infrastructure and multicloud environments that address the dominant qualities of a data-centric services platform. The next-generation data services platform is defined by its ability to continuously discover, protect, govern, move, optimize, and operationalize data autonomously across the entire enterprise. In summary, IPCS platforms are focused on modernizing IT operations.

The market has anticipated a broader enterprise trend: Organizations are increasingly distinguishing between where workloads run and how infrastructure is operated. While public cloud remains a critical deployment option, many enterprises are gravitating toward a hybrid cloud operating model that applies cloud-based consumption, automation and service delivery principles across diverse infrastructure locations.

For organizations operating mission- and business-critical workloads, IPCS platforms provide a compelling alternative to hyperscaler centralization. They combine platform economics, operational automation, and consumption-based delivery with the flexibility, governance, resilience, and workload mobility required by modern enterprises. As infrastructure, data, and AI become more tightly interconnected, IPCS platforms are positioned to serve as the operational foundation for the next generation of hybrid cloud environments.

Limited vendor disclosure data indicates that the IPCS market has already surpassed \$5 billion in recurring revenue among reporting vendors alone. Given that several major providers do not disclose stand-alone IPCS ARR, actual market recurring revenue is materially higher and has accumulated more than \$15 billion in total contract value (TCV). This growth reflects increasing enterprise demand for operational models that combine cloudlike agility with infrastructure flexibility and control.

The market encompasses vendors spanning storage, compute, and data services domains. Many providers are actively transforming their business models, organizational structures, and go-to-market strategies to position themselves as platform operators rather than solely as product suppliers. As a result, competitive differentiation is increasingly measured by platform capabilities, service outcomes, and ecosystem integration rather than infrastructure hardware features alone.

The next phase of the hybrid cloud market is focused on platform intelligence — transforming the infrastructure platform into a decision-making system that delivers business outcomes through AI-driven insights, predictive analytics, and automated remediation. IPCS vendor roadmaps increasingly emphasize:

- Integration of ecosystemwide data services, such as backup and disaster recovery, within platform control planes
- Hybrid environment-spanning telemetry collection and analytics
- AI-driven operational insights and predictive optimization
- Automated capacity, performance, and cost management
- Cyber detection and resilience services
- Ransomware protection and recovery capabilities
- Disaster recovery orchestration
- Data sovereignty
- Sustainability optimization for energy efficiency and carbon reduction

This is the second annual Magic Quadrant for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services. For further guidance, a more detailed analysis of the service providers' capabilities with scoring based on different use cases is available in Critical Capabilities for Infrastructure Platform Consumption Services.

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